Progressive Muscle RELAXATION

12-18 year olds

When in fight or flight mode, our bodies might feel tense. Our muscles can feel stiff or sore. This muscle relaxation technique can help us become more aware of this, and help us address it.

SQUEEZE AND RELAX TECHNIQUE GET COMFORTABLE!

First it would be good to get into a comfortable position. You may want to sit or lie down and close your eyes. If you don't feel comfortable closing your eyes, that is okay too.

LETS START WITH YOUR LEGS

1. Tense the muscles in your toes by curling them into your foot. Hold your feet tense for 5 seconds. Notice how it feels when your foot feels tense.
2. Now relax your feet and release the tension. Notice how your feet feel different now this tension is released.
3. Now move to your calf, tense all of the muscles in your calf. Hold this for 5 seconds. Notice how this feels when your calf is tensed.
4. Release this tension now. Notice the difference now that your calf is relaxed.
5. Next tense your thighs. Hold this for 5 seconds. Notice how it feels with the tension in your thigh.
6. Now relax your thigh muscles. Notice how this feels now that your thigh is relaxed.

FOLLOW THIS PATTERN THROUGH THE REST OF YOUR BODY.

Now repeat this process across your body. Move up to your core. Then through your arms, to your neck and your head. Keep noticing how these parts of your body feel when tensed and then relaxed.

Adapted from:
Therapist Aid. (2013). https://www.therapistaid.com/therapy-worksheet/relaxation-techniques